



The Black Panthers, a black nationalist group based in Oakland, California, argued for working class unity. Here supporters hold up copies of Mao Zedong's *Little Red Book*.

WITH INCREASED FIGHTING IN VIETNAM, 1966 SAW THE US

launch its **largest offensive** against the Viet Cong in Operation Crimp, to capture the Viet Cong's Saigon area headquarters. By the end of 1966, the number of US troops in Vietnam had reached 385,000, amid **increased public protests** about the war.

Pakistani and **Indian** leaders met more peacefully in January at Tashkent in Uzbekistan to sign a declaration agreeing to resolve their dispute (see 1965) by **peaceful means**. Shortly afterward, Lal Bahadur Shastri, prime minister of India, died of a heart attack. He was succeeded by Indira Gandhi, daughter of Nehru.

In **Northern Ireland**, violence erupted following the 50th anniversaries of the Battle of the Somme and the Easter Rising—symbolic dates for Protestants and Catholics respectively. The murder of two Catholics by a “loyalist” terror group called the **Ulster Volunteer Force (UVF)** sparked more riots in May and June. The UVF was banned, but the cycle of sectarian killings, known as **the Troubles**, had begun.

The shock assassination of **Hendrik Verwoerd**, prime minister of South Africa and the architect of apartheid, raised queries about the future of South Africa. He was stabbed to death on September 6 by Dimitri Tsafendas, who claimed not enough was being done for whites.

Race continued to be a dominant issue in the US, with **race riots** occurring in many cities throughout



KEY

- North Vietnam
- South Vietnam
- Demilitarized zone

State of play in Vietnam

This map shows North and South Vietnam in 1964, divided by a demilitarized zone. In 1966 the North Vietnamese crossed the zone and one of the largest battles to date broke out near Dong Ha.

the mid-1960s. Student radicals were becoming impatient with Martin Luther King's strategy of nonviolence, and in June, activist Stokely Carmichael popularized the term “**Black Power**.” In October he formed the **Black Panther Party**, combining traditional civil rights slogans with Marxist rhetoric, and the language of black separatism.



The Little Red Book

Full of Mao's quotations, this book added to his cult and had a profound impact on the masses during the Chinese Cultural Revolution.

In August, Chinese communist leader Mao Zedong launched the **Cultural Revolution**, aiming to purge the country of “impure” elements. One-and-a-half million people died and much of the country's cultural heritage was destroyed. In September 1967, with many Chinese cities on the verge of anarchy, Mao sent in the army to restore order.

By the end of 1966, the decade known as the “**Swinging Sixties**”—so called because of the collapse of social taboos relating to race, sex, and gender—was in full flow. It was epitomized by rock music, photography, and fashion, with London and youth culture at its heart.



Donald Campbell was attempting to break the world speed record when his speedboat *Bluebird* crashed, killing him instantly.

THE YEAR BEGAN WITH THE TRAGIC DEATH OF DONALD CAMPBELL,

who was killed on January 4 at Coniston Water in the Lake District, England, while attempting to break his own **water speed record**. He was traveling at more than 300mph (480 kph) when his boat flipped.

Tensions were running high in the Middle East after Egypt asked for UN forces in the Sinai to be removed. The Israelis responded with a **pre-emptive attack**, which ended after six days with Israel in control of Sinai, Gaza, the West Bank, the Golan Heights, and Jerusalem.

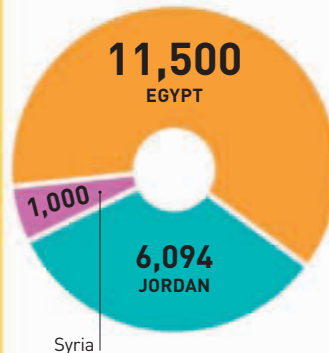
Meanwhile, in Bolivia, **Ernesto “Che” Guevara** (see panel, right) was captured and shot dead, on the Bolivian president's orders, on 9 June. Guevara was in Latin America helping guerrilla groups.

More interested in saving lives, South African surgeon Christiaan



CHE GUEVARA (1928–67)

Ernesto “Che” Guevara was born in Argentina in 1928, and became involved in the opposition to Juan Peron. He traveled extensively through Latin America, where he saw poverty and social injustice that helped forge his radical political views. Che became an associate of Fidel Castro, and played a role in the fight for Cuba. He left Cuba to help revolutionaries abroad, and was executed in Bolivia.



Casualties in the Six-Day War

Israel won a decisive victory in the Six-Day War between Israel, Egypt, Jordan, and Syria, with 759 casualties. Arab losses, in contrast, were high.

Barnard conducted the **first heart transplant** on December 3. Although the patient died later of pneumonia, the procedure was a great step forward for medicine.

In Europe, Nicolae **Ceausescu** became premier of **Romania** on December 9, defying the Soviets by establishing diplomatic relations with Germany.

In **Greece**, after army officers seized power on April 21, a counter coup by King Constantine II failed, and he fled to Rome.

